

TechCorp Inc.

IT Helpdesk & Employee Technology Support Guide

Version 3.1 | Effective Date: January 2025 | IT Department

1. Introduction & Scope

This document serves as the official IT Helpdesk and Employee Technology Support Guide for TechCorp Inc. It covers all IT-related policies, procedures, and support resources available to employees. All employees, contractors, and vendors with access to TechCorp systems are bound by these policies.

2. Password Policy

Strong passwords are the first line of defense against unauthorized access. TechCorp enforces the following password standards:

2.1 Password Requirements

- Minimum length: 12 characters
- Must include at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character (!@#\$%^&*)
- Passwords must not contain your username, first name, last name, or company name
- Passwords cannot be reused for the last 10 password cycles
- Passwords expire every 90 days; users receive a 14-day advance warning
- Account is locked after 5 consecutive failed login attempts

2.2 Password Reset Procedure

To reset your password, visit the Self-Service Password Reset (SSPR) portal at <https://password.techcorp.internal>. You will need to verify your identity using multi-factor authentication (MFA). If you are locked out and cannot access the portal, call the IT Helpdesk at extension 4357 (HELP) or email helpdesk@techcorp.com. Identity verification via manager approval is required for phone-based resets.

2.3 Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

MFA is mandatory for all employees accessing corporate systems from external networks and for all privileged accounts. Supported MFA methods include the Microsoft Authenticator app (recommended), SMS one-time passcodes, and hardware security keys (YubiKey). MFA enrollment must be completed within 3 days of account creation.

3. VPN Access & Remote Work

TechCorp uses Cisco AnyConnect VPN for secure remote access to internal systems.

3.1 VPN Setup Instructions

1. Download Cisco AnyConnect from the Software Center or the IT Portal at <https://itportal.techcorp.internal>
2. Install the application following the on-screen instructions
3. Open AnyConnect and enter the server address: `vpn.techcorp.com`
4. Enter your corporate credentials (same as your Windows login)
5. Approve the MFA prompt on your registered device
6. You are now connected — the AnyConnect icon in the system tray will show a lock symbol

3.2 VPN Troubleshooting

- Cannot connect to VPN: Verify your internet connection, then try disconnecting and reconnecting. Ensure you are using the correct server address `vpn.techcorp.com`.
- MFA prompt not appearing: Open the Microsoft Authenticator app manually and check for a pending request.
- VPN drops frequently: Switch from Wi-Fi to a wired connection if possible. If on Wi-Fi, ensure you are using the 5GHz band.
- Slow performance on VPN: Close bandwidth-heavy applications. Use Split Tunnel mode by contacting the helpdesk to enable it for your account.

4. Hardware & Equipment

4.1 Laptop Request & Replacement

New employees receive their laptop within 2 business days of their start date. Standard issue is a Dell Latitude 5540 (Windows 11) or MacBook Pro 14-inch (macOS Ventura) depending on role. To request a replacement for a damaged or underperforming device, submit a Hardware Request ticket through the IT Portal. Approved replacements are processed within 5–7 business days. Loaner laptops are available for urgent cases.

4.2 Peripheral Equipment

Each employee is entitled to one external monitor, one keyboard, and one mouse at no cost. Additional peripherals (docking stations, webcams, headsets) require manager approval and are subject to budget availability. Peripherals are requested via the IT Portal under the 'Equipment Request' category.

4.3 Equipment Loss or Theft

Report lost or stolen devices immediately to the IT Security team at security@techcorp.com and to your manager. Remote device wipe will be initiated within 1 hour of the report. A police report number is

required for insurance purposes. Employees found to be negligent in securing company property may be held financially responsible.

5. Software & Application Access

5.1 Approved Software List

TechCorp maintains an approved software catalog available in the Software Center application on all managed devices. Employees may self-install any software listed in the catalog without IT approval. The catalog includes Microsoft 365 Suite, Slack, Zoom, Chrome, Firefox, VS Code, PyCharm, Docker Desktop, and Postman, among others.

5.2 Requesting New Software

To request software not in the catalog, submit a Software Request ticket with the business justification, vendor name, license cost, and manager approval. The IT Security team will perform a security review within 5 business days. Unapproved software must not be installed on corporate devices. Violations may result in disciplinary action.

5.3 Microsoft 365 & Email

All employees have access to Microsoft 365 including Outlook, Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, and SharePoint. Email storage limit is 100 GB. OneDrive storage is 1 TB per user. For Outlook configuration on personal devices, use the server: outlook.office365.com with your full email as the username.

6. Network & Internet Access

6.1 Wi-Fi Networks

- TechCorp-Corporate: For all company-owned devices. Use your corporate login credentials.
- TechCorp-Guest: For personal devices and visitors. No access to internal resources.
- TechCorp-IOT: For smart devices, printers, and conference room equipment only.

6.2 Internet Usage Policy

Internet access is provided for business purposes. Limited personal use is permitted during breaks. Prohibited activities include downloading pirated software or media, accessing gambling or adult content sites, using personal cloud storage (Google Drive, Dropbox) for company data, and cryptocurrency mining. All internet traffic is monitored and logged for security compliance.

7. Contacting IT Support

7.1 Support Channels & Hours

- IT Portal (Self-Service): <https://itportal.techcorp.internal> — Available 24/7 for ticket submission and tracking
- Phone: Extension 4357 (HELP) — Monday to Friday, 7:00 AM to 8:00 PM local time
- Email: helpdesk@techcorp.com — Response within 4 business hours
- Live Chat: Available in the IT Portal during business hours
- Emergency (after hours): Extension 4911 for critical system outages only

7.2 Ticket Priority Levels

- P1 - Critical: Complete system outage affecting production or multiple users. Response time: 30 minutes.
- P2 - High: Major functionality impaired, significant business impact. Response time: 2 hours.
- P3 - Medium: Partial functionality loss, moderate impact. Response time: 8 business hours.
- P4 - Low: Minor issues, requests, questions. Response time: 24–48 business hours.

7.3 Self-Service Resources

Before contacting IT support, employees are encouraged to check the IT Knowledge Base at <https://kb.techcorp.internal>. It contains step-by-step guides for the most common issues including printer setup, VPN troubleshooting, email configuration, and software installation. The Knowledge Base is searchable and updated weekly.

8. IT Security & Compliance

8.1 Data Classification

TechCorp classifies data into four levels: Public (shareable externally), Internal (employees only), Confidential (restricted to specific teams), and Restricted (executives and legal only, e.g., M&A; data, PII). All documents should be labeled with the appropriate classification tag. Sharing Restricted or Confidential data outside approved channels is a policy violation.

8.2 Phishing & Social Engineering

Phishing is the most common attack vector. Do not click links or download attachments from unexpected emails. IT will never ask for your password via email or phone. Report suspicious emails using the 'Report Phishing' button in Outlook or forward to phishing@techcorp.com. Employees who click simulated phishing emails will be enrolled in mandatory security awareness training.

8.3 Incident Reporting

Report any suspected security incident, data breach, or unauthorized access immediately to the IT Security team. Use the red 'Report Security Incident' button on the IT Portal homepage or call the security hotline at extension 4911. Early reporting is critical — employees who promptly report incidents will not face disciplinary action for honest mistakes.

9. Onboarding & Offboarding

9.1 New Employee Onboarding

New employees should receive their laptop, credentials, and access badge on their first day. IT onboarding includes system account setup, MFA enrollment, VPN configuration, and a 30-minute IT orientation session. Access to department-specific systems is provisioned based on the access request submitted by the hiring manager at least 3 days before the start date.

9.2 Employee Offboarding

When an employee leaves TechCorp, managers must submit an offboarding request via the HR Portal at least 24 hours before the last day. All system access is revoked on the employee's last day at 5:00 PM. Company devices must be returned to IT within 2 business days. Personal data should be removed from company devices prior to return. Email forwarding is available for up to 30 days post-departure by manager request.